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Welcome to ENT207TC Digital Startup Lab

ENT207TC · WEEK 1 KICKOFF

Digital Startup Lab

Ten weeks from a problem worth solving to a working app you demo in public.

Bogdan Marculescu · Stefan Seedorf · Semester 1, 2026–27

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01

The ENT207TC module

“Think of this lab not as a classroom, but as a startup studio.

You are not just students, you are designers, founders, analysts, and creators.”

— ENT207TC Module Handbook

What the module aims to do

Build with current technology

An in-depth understanding of what is now buildable: AI, AI agents, no-code and low-code platforms, and emerging tools.

Work like a startup

Structured product development through milestone-based learning, Kanban workflow management and iterative prototyping.

Handle the hard parts

Emotional intelligence and resilience for the highs and lows that come with building something real, in a team, under time pressure.

What you will do

-Identify a problem worth solving and frame it clearly.

-Sketch multiple solutions, then wireframe the one you choose.

-Turn the sketches into an interactive digital prototype.

-Build a working MVP app on the platform or stack of your choice.

-Use AI agents to augment your product or automate part of its workflow.

-Promote it, test it with at least ten real users, and pitch it in Demo Day.

The semester in four phases

WEEKS 1–3

Decision

problem, prototype · CP1

WEEKS 4–7

Building

app, 3 features · CP2

WEEKS 8–9

Promoting

users, fixes · CP3

WEEK 10

Demo Day

live demo and video

WEEK 11

Submission

all documentation

Three formal checkpoints sit at the end of Weeks 3, 7 and 9. At each one you present to your mentor.

How the group is assessed

COMPONENT	WEIGHT	WHAT IT COVERS
Weekly Process	40%	Weekly milestone deliverables, Kanban maintenance, documented progress
Final Deliverables	30%	Drafts, three checkpoint reports, prototype, promotion and user testing reports
Demo Day	20%	Live demo and Q&A, plus a professionally edited video with subtitles
Journey Reflection	10%	End-of-semester group reflection on process, support and tools

What counts as a finished product

-A user-facing interface: an app, a dashboard or a web tool.

-Real user input and interaction — form, voice, chat or data upload.

-At least five screens with structured navigation, and working login.

-**Three core features** with logic behind them. A landing page is not a feature.

-Tested with at least ten real users, with a clearly defined use case.

02

ENT207TC: People and platform

Who supports you

Module leaders

Bogdan Marculescu and Stefan Seedorf run the sessions, set the structure and make the final assessment decisions.

Bogdan.Marculescu@xjtlu.edu.cn
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EEH Mentors

Your assigned mentor pushes your thinking, connects you to expertise and reviews you at each checkpoint. Talk to them about the project, not about logistics.

Teaching Assistants

Your TA handles all administration: check-ins, submissions, deliverable verification and anything procedural.

Your mentors

Khalid Akhal

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CN.UnoAnalyzer.com

-Every student on the module gets a free account. This is your team's workspace for the semester.

-Create your group, or join the one your teammates created.

-Browse the industry projects to see what real organisations are asking for.

-Run your Kanban board there; cards and their movements are recorded as evidence of who did what.

03

ENT207TC Week 1

This week, step by step

01

Form your group

Around seven members, formed on shared project interest. Then create the group in unoanalyzer and all join it.

02

Browse industry projects

Read through the industry projects listed in unoanalyzer. They are the fastest route to a problem someone actually has.

03

List problems

Write down several problems your team would like to solve. Quantity first — you are not committing to anything yet.

04

Argue about them

Discuss which of those problems are worth solving: who has the problem, how badly, and whether you can reach those people.

05

Sketch solutions

For the strongest problems, outline digital solutions you could realistically build in a few weeks — you need a working app by Week 7.

06

Set up and submit

Create your Kanban board in UnoAnalyzer, then submit your group composition and problem ideas through the weekly milestone form.

How ideas get validated

Green

Clear problem, realistic and buildable solution. The team proceeds to development.

Yellow

Valid problem, but the solution needs more clarity or scoping. Revise and resubmit.

Red

Problem unclear or solution unrealistic. Full pivot required.

You will present your ideas to another group first, using this system, before mentors review them.

To do this week

-Finalize your group: have a team name, members, and a group leader.

-Meet your mentor, your TA

-Check the projects, make a not of those interesting to you

-Talk in your group about your problem ideas, write a sentence on each.

-Setup your Kanban board and take a photo after you set it up with 2 tasks for each.

-Log 1 proof (photo).

Now form your groups

Questions about the project go to your mentor.
Questions about submissions go to your TA.

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